

YOU'RE GONNA NEED A BIGGER BOAT

JAWS / 1975

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Action adventure

DIRECTOR

Steven Spielberg

WRITERS

Peter Benchley, Carl Gottlieb (screenplay); Peter Benchley (novel)

STARS

Roy Scheider, Richard Dreyfuss, Robert Shaw, Lorraine Gary

BEFORE

1971 In Spielberg's thriller *Duel*, a driver is chased by a truck.

AFTER

1977 *Close Encounters of the Third Kind* is Spielberg's ambitious sci-fi drama.

1993 In his blockbuster *Jurassic Park*, Spielberg brings dinosaurs back from extinction.

There are many memorable lines in *Jaws*, but "You're gonna need a bigger boat" is the one most people remember. It comes just after Brody (Roy Scheider), the aquaphobic police chief of Amity Island, first sees his nemesis: the great white shark,

which smashes out of the water, mouth gaping, heading straight for the audience in their seats.

The shark's first victim is lone skinny-dipper Chrissie (Susan Backlinie). The attacker is all the more terrifying for being unseen.

